

Reading: Upgrading macOS

Estimated duration: 2 minutes

Learning objectives

- Identify the importance of upgrading and maintaining the macOS system.
- Describe the process of setting up auto upgrade, upgrading the OS, and updating applications.
- Explain the importance of backups during upgrading the OS and applications.

This comprehensive guide will walk you through the process of upgrading macOS, including setting up automatic upgrades, upgrading OS, and updating your applications.

Upgrading macOS

Before you upgrade, create a full backup of your important files and data to protect against unforeseen issues during the upgrade process. Verify that your Mac meets the system requirements for the latest version of macOS. Visit the Apple website or the App Store to find the minimum requirements for the macOS version you want. Follow these steps to upgrade macOS:

- Open the App Store from the Dock or the Applications folder.
- Search the App Store for the latest macOS version and click the 'Get' or 'Download' button to start the download and installation process.
- Follow the on-screen instructions to complete the upgrade. You may need to restart your Mac several times during the installation process.

There is also a method to set up the upgrades automatically. When this setting is enabled, your Mac will automatically download and install macOS updates in the background so that you are always up to date without having to manually intervene.

Updating Applications

After upgrading macOS, be sure to update your applications to ensure compatibility and to take advantage of the new features and improvements.

You may be prompted to enter your Apple ID and password to authenticate updates. Also, some applications may provide their own built-in update mechanism. Check the application's preferences or settings to see if there is an option to update directly from within the application. Keep in mind that during the upgrade process, some applications may not be immediately compatible with the new macOS version. In such cases, it is recommended to visit the developers' websites to check for available updates or compatibility announcements.

By setting up automatic upgrades, upgrading your macOS operating system, and updating your applications, you can ensure that your Mac stays up-to-date with the latest features, security patches, and performance enhancements. Regular upgrades are critical to maintaining the overall functionality and security of your macOS system and providing you with a smooth and optimized user experience.

Author(s)

Shaun Manzano

Other Contributor(s)

Andrew Pfeiffer



Skills Network